

From Justification toward Sanctification

Pocket Card — The Five Steps · A Practice for Living What You Already Believe · NLT
Print, fold, and carry. Read before it is needed; use it when it is.

When an unwanted impulse rises, before you speak or act:

1. Notice — Something is rising. Pause three seconds. It is not the whole of who you are in Christ.

Cue: "What is rising in me right now?" — Psalm 4:4; Ephesians 4:26

2. Discern — Sinful nature, or Spirit's fruit? (Galatians 5:19–23)

Cue: "Which list does this belong to?"

3. Declare — Speak the word you already hid in your heart into this exact moment.

Cue: "This is what's true here" — Romans 12:2; Psalm 119:11

4. Return — A brief prayer. Peace follows; it does not come first.

Cue: "Lord, rule here. Help me love them." — Philippians 4:6; James 4:8

5. Act — Obey now. Do not wait to feel it first.

Cue: "Do it while it still costs something." — James 1:22; Galatians 5:25

Quick scripts

Anger: Ephesians 4:26 — "Don't sin by letting anger control you."

Anxiety: Philippians 4:6 — "Pray about everything."

Phone / night scroll: Philippians 4:6 — then put it down.

Envy: 1 Corinthians 13:4 — "Love is not jealous."

Bitterness: Ephesians 4:31–32 — "Be kind... tenderhearted, forgiving one another."

The goal is fruit — not emptiness.

Grace trains. Word aligns. Community bears the load.

Justified once. Sanctified daily.